Bella and the Very Long Wait

A Royal Butterflies Story

by Cornillius Denson

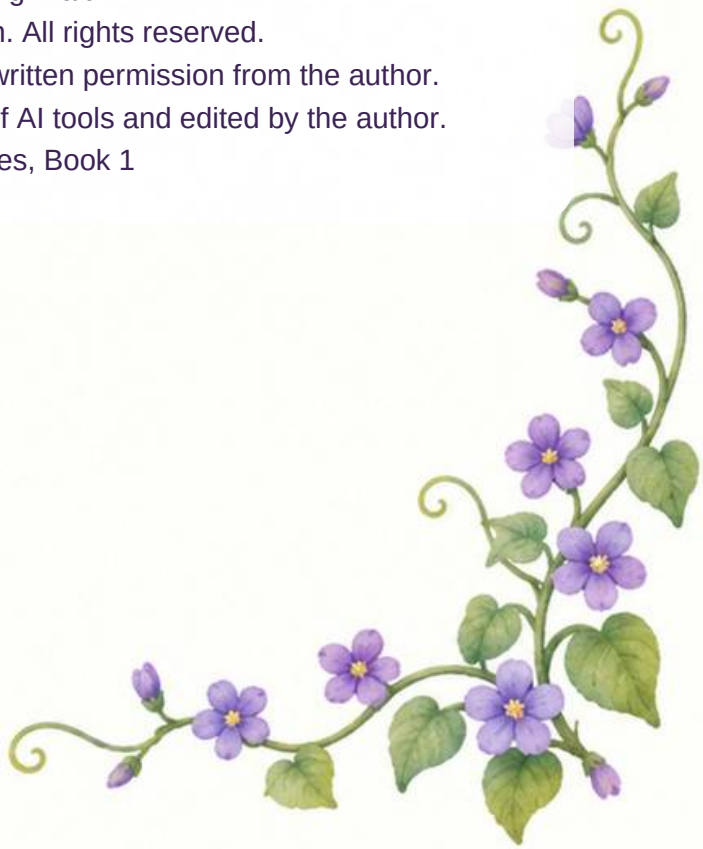


Bella and the Very Long Wait

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The Royal Butterflies series, Book 1



To all the Royal Butterflies around the globe: may your wings carry you as far as your dreams can fly.

— Cornillius Denson




In a cozy storybook town, where flowers line every street and lanterns glow at night, lived a girl named Bella.


Bella had a silver tiara with one bright blue gem. Every morning it sparkled, and every morning she wanted to go, go, GO!


Her best friend, King Jay, never hurried. "Slow down, Bella," he said. "Come meet Pip!" On a leaf sat a round little caterpillar with a fluffy tuft on his head.

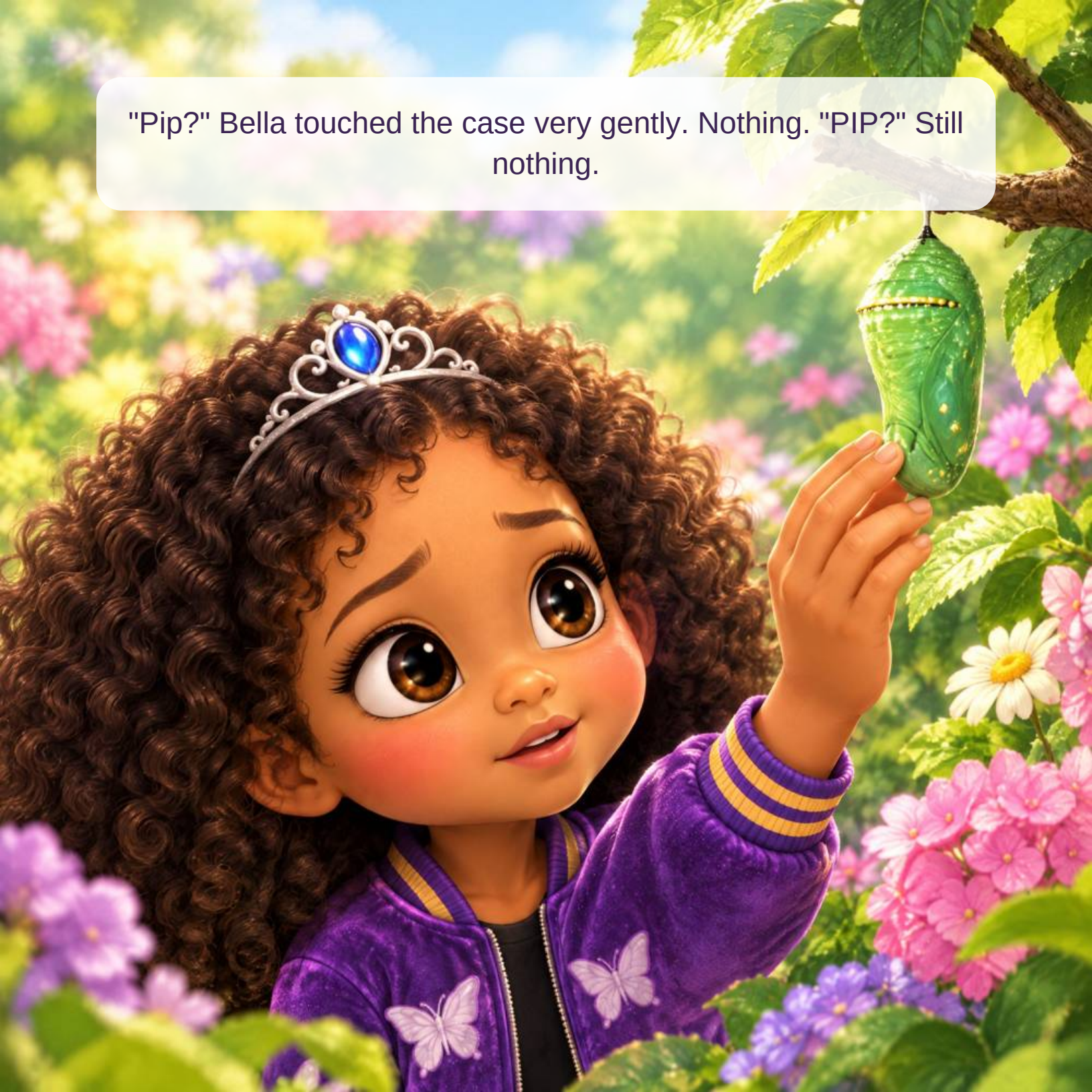
They played hide-and-seek with Goldie by the big flower bushes, and Pip watched from his leaf. Bella always won. Pip always looked like he was laughing.




But one day, Pip was very still. He didn't munch. He didn't wiggle. He just looked sleepy. A big kind of sleepy.

Pip climbed up a twig, held on tight, and hung down like the letter J. Then his skin split, and underneath was a smooth green case.




"Pip?" Bella touched the case very gently. Nothing. "PIP?" Still nothing.


Bella's shoulders drooped. Her tiara didn't sparkle at all. "He's gone," she whispered.


Professor Flutter sat down beside her. "Is he gone?" he asked kindly. "Or is he busy?"


In his pink lab, the Professor showed Bella another chrysalis under a glass dome. "Inside, a caterpillar's body is being rebuilt into a butterfly," he said. "That's called metamorphosis."


"How long?" asked Bella. "As long as it takes," said the Professor. Bella flopped onto a beanbag. That was the longest answer ever.


"Waiting is easier when you stay busy," said the Professor.
"Come. The garden is full of butterflies."


Bella watched a butterfly uncurl a long, straw-like tongue called a proboscis and sip sweet nectar. When it finished, the proboscis curled back up.


Then the butterfly landed on a leaf. "It's tasting the leaf with its feet," said the Professor. Bella giggled. "I'm glad I don't do that!"

King Jay and Goldie came to help. Together they planted flowers for the butterflies. It was slow. It was muddy. It was kind of fun.




Every evening, Bella visited Pip. "Today I planted flowers," she told him. "You'd have liked that."


Days passed. One morning the chrysalis turned see-through, and Bella saw a flash of magenta inside!


The case cracked. Something wriggled. Something pushed.
Out came... wings! Crumpled, damp and magenta.


"Pip?" whispered Bella. The new butterfly looked up. On his head was a little fluffy tuft.


Pip fluttered down and landed on Bella's hand. "Took you long enough," Bella whispered, and she smiled the biggest smile.


Pip rested in the sun while his wings dried and spread. Bella didn't hurry him, not even a little.


That night, under the lanterns, King Jay set a tiny seed-husk crown on Pip. "For patience," he said. Everyone cheered.


And Bella's tiara sparkled brighter than ever, because now she knew: change takes time, and friends are worth the wait.

Real Butterfly Facts

1. Butterflies taste with their feet.
2. Their wings are covered in tiny scales. The word Lepidoptera means “scale wing.”
3. They drink nectar through a straw-like proboscis that coils up when they’re not using it.
4. Inside a chrysalis, a caterpillar’s body is rebuilt into a butterfly’s body. This is called metamorphosis.






Coming soon: The Bravest Little Wing
Color Bella's world in the *Bella and the Very Long Wait Coloring Book!*